



Course 3 overview: Set your expectations

Welcome to the third course in the Google Data Analytics Certificate program! So far, you've been introduced to the field of data analytics and discovered how data analysts use their skills to answer business questions.

As you work through this course, you'll identify and explore different types of data and data structures that can be used to understand and respond to a business problem. Then, you'll learn to identify any bias in data and to verify its credibility. You'll keep adding to your data analyst tool box by further exploring data within spreadsheets and databases. Finally, you'll learn more about engaging with the data community and manage your online presence. All of these skills will come in handy, no matter where your career as a data analyst takes you.



1. [Foundations: Data, Data, Everywhere](#)
2. [Ask Questions to Make Data-Driven Decisions](#)
3. Prepare Data for Exploration (this course)
4. [Process Data from Dirty to Clean](#)
5. [Analyze Data to Answer Questions](#)
6. [Share Data Through the Art of Visualization](#)
7. [Data Analysis with R Programming](#)

8. [Google Data Analytics Capstone: Complete a Case Study](#)

Course content

Each course in this program is broken into modules. Each one is designed to familiarize you with different data structures and show you how to collect, verify, and organize data. You will work on a wide range of activities that are similar to on-the-job tasks that data analysts come across on a daily basis.

Here's an overview of the skills you'll learn in each module.

Module 1: Data types and structures

A massive amount of data is generated every single day. In this part of the course, you will discover how this data is generated and how analysts decide which data to use for analysis. You'll also learn about structured and unstructured data, data types, and data formats as you start thinking about how to prepare your data for analysis.

Module 2: Data responsibility

Before you work with data, you must confirm that it is unbiased and credible. After all, if you start your analysis with unreliable data, you won't be able to trust your results. In this part of the course, you will learn to identify bias in data and to ensure your data is credible. You'll also explore open data and the importance of data ethics and data privacy.

Module 3: Database essentials

When you analyze large datasets, you'll access much of the data from a database. In this part of the course, you will learn about databases, including how to access them and extract, filter, and sort the data they contain. You'll also explore metadata to discover its many **facets** and how analysts use it to better understand their data.

Module 4: Organize and protect data

Good organizational skills are a big part of most types of work, especially data analytics. In this part of the course, you will learn best practices for organizing data and keeping it secure. You'll also understand how analysts use file naming **conventions** to help them keep their work organized.

Module 5: Engage in the data community

Having a strong online presence can be a big help for job seekers of all kinds. In this part of the course, you will explore how to manage your online presence. You'll also discover the benefits of networking with other data analytics professionals.

What to expect

Each course offers many types of learning opportunities:

- Videos for instructors to teach new concepts and demonstrate the use of tools
- In-video questions that pop up from time to time to help you to check your understanding of key concepts and skills
- Step-by-step guides you can use to follow along with instructors as they demonstrate tools
- Readings to explore topics more in-depth and build on the concepts from the videos
- Connect with other learners: If you have a question, chances are, you're not alone. Visit Coursera's private [Data Analytics Community](#) to expand your network, discuss career journeys, and share experiences. Check out the [quick start guide](#).
- Practice quizzes to prepare you for graded quizzes
- Graded quizzes to measure your progress and give you valuable feedback

This program was designed to let you work at your own pace—your personalized deadlines are just a guide. There is no penalty for late assignments. To earn your certificate, you simply need to complete all of the work.

If you miss two assessment deadlines in a row, or if you miss an assessment deadline by two weeks, you'll see a Reset deadlines option on the Grades page. Click it to switch to a new course schedule with updated deadlines. You can use this option as many times as you need—it won't remove any progress you've already made in the course, but you may find new course content if the instructor updated the course after you started. If you cancel a subscription and then reactivate it, your deadlines will automatically reset.

In this course, you'll be assessed with graded quizzes and activities. Both are based on the wide variety of learning materials and activities that reinforce the important skills you'll develop. And both can be taken more than once.

Tips for success

- It is strongly recommended that you go through the items in each lesson in the order they appear because new information and concepts build on previous knowledge.
- Participate in all learning opportunities to gain as much knowledge and experience as possible.
- If something is confusing, don't hesitate to replay a video, review a reading, or repeat a self-review activity.
- Use the additional resources that are referenced in this course. They are designed to support your learning. You can find all of these resources in the [Resources](#) tab.
- When you encounter useful links in this course, bookmark them so you can refer to the information later for study or review.
- Understand and follow the [Coursera Code of Conduct](#) to ensure that the learning community remains a welcoming, friendly, and supportive place for all members.

Updates to the course

As you complete this course, you may notice updates to the content, like new practice materials and additional examples. These updates ensure the program provides up-to-date skills and guidance that will help you in your data analytics career. If you previously completed a graded activity, you *may* need to repeat the assessment in order to complete this course. For more information, check out the [Community](#).